

Unit 16 Mark's Gospel

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of St Mark's Gospel and its effects on the lives of Christians in the UK. There are four sections covering discipleship, conflict and argument, death and resurrection, and the identity of Jesus.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 16.1 Discipleship

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — the commandments, disciples, the eye of a needle, the kingdom, Levi, Peter's denial, self-sacrifice, service, Sons of Zebedee, true family, true greatness, the Twelve

- How the nature of discipleship is shown in the call of the first disciples (1:14-20, 2:13-17), and why it is important for Christians today.
- How the nature of discipleship is shown in the sending out of the Twelve (6:7-13), and how it affects ideas about Christian living today.
- How the costs of discipleship are shown in the true family of Jesus (3:31-35), and why this teaching causes problems for some Christians today.
- How the costs of discipleship are shown in true greatness (9:33-37), and why this teaching causes problems for some Christians today.
- How the costs of discipleship are shown in the rich man (10:17-31), and why this teaching causes problems for some Christians today.
- How the costs of discipleship are shown in the parable of the tenants (12:1-12), and its relationship to Christians today.
- How the problems of discipleship are shown in the spirit cast out of the boy (9:14-29), and why this teaching causes problems for some Christians today.
- How the problems of discipleship are shown in the parable of the sower (4:1-20), and why Mark's account causes problems for Christians today.
- How the problems of discipleship are shown in Jesus and service (10:41-45), and what it means for Christian living today.
- How the problems of discipleship are shown in the failure of the disciples (14:27-42), and how it might both help and cause problems for Christians today.
- How the problems of discipleship are shown in Peter's denial (14:66-72), and how it might both help and cause problems for Christians today.